

ACTION PLAN

The 30-Day Burnout Prevention Action Plan

Stop surviving burnout. Start building a life that doesn't cause it.

\$4.99

AiFactory · Aurislumen · June 2026

Stop surviving burnout. Start building a life that doesn't cause it.

What's Inside

- A clear day-by-day action plan across 30 days so you always know exactly what to do next — no guesswork, no overwhelm
- Weekly focus phases that systematically address the root causes of burnout, not just the symptoms you can see on the surface
- Boundary-setting and workload redesign frameworks that protect your energy without derailing your career or relationships
- Built-in recovery rituals and check-in prompts that make sustainable performance your new default — not something you have to fight for

The 30-Day Burnout Prevention Action Plan

For professionals who fixed the crisis but need to fix the structure.

HOW THIS WORKS

Burnout returns because the conditions that caused it never changed. This plan runs in four weekly phases. Each phase builds on the last. By Day 30, you'll have a functioning system — not just temporary relief.

Time investment: 5–10 minutes daily, 15 minutes weekly.

Start date: Today.

YOUR DAILY NON-NEGOTIABLES

Do these every day for all 30 days. Non-negotiable means non-negotiable.

- [] **Sleep anchor** — Same bedtime and wake time, within 30 minutes, every day (including weekends)

- [] **One full off-screen meal** — Eat at least one meal per day without a screen or work content

- [] **10-minute decompression gap** — A hard stop between work and personal time (walk, stretch, sit outside — no content consumption)

These aren't wellness extras. They are the floor. If you skip them, you're not recovering — you're resting before the next crash.

WEEK 1: STABILIZE

Goal: Stop the bleeding. Reduce immediate load without guilt.

THIS WEEK'S 3 ACTIONS

Action 1: Audit your current commitments

Write down every recurring commitment — meetings, projects, obligations, side requests. Next to each one, write: *Essential / Can reduce / Can eliminate*. Do not negotiate with yourself. If you're burned out, something has to go.

Action 2: Set one hard boundary this week

Identify the single biggest source of overflow (after-hours Slack, meeting creep, chronic yes-saying). Implement one concrete limit: an out-of-office auto-reply after 6pm, blocking your calendar Thursday afternoons, or sending one "I can't take this on" email. One boundary. This week.

Action 3: Identify your three highest-drain tasks

Not the most important — the most draining. Write them down. For each one, note: Can I delegate this? Can I batch it? Can I shorten it? You're not solving it yet. You're naming it.

WEEK 2: RESTORE

Goal: Rebuild basic capacity. Energy before productivity.

THIS WEEK'S 3 ACTIONS

Action 1: Schedule two true recovery blocks

Block two 90-minute windows this week — on your actual calendar — for something that genuinely restores you (not sleep, not errands). This could be exercise, a hobby, unstructured time outside. Treat these as client appointments. They are not rewards. They are inputs.

Action 2: Renegotiate one deadline or deliverable

Go back to your commitment audit from Week 1. Choose one item and renegotiate it — push the deadline, reduce the scope, or ask for help. Most deadlines are softer than you've told yourself. Do this before you feel desperate.

Action 3: Reconnect with one person outside of work

Not a networking contact. Someone who has nothing to do with your job. A friend, a family member, a former version of your social life. One conversation. In person or by phone — not text.

WEEK 3: RESTRUCTURE

Goal: Change the underlying system so overload can't quietly rebuild.

THIS WEEK'S 3 ACTIONS

Action 1: Design your "maximum viable week"

Using your calendar, map out what a week looks like when you're functioning well — not your dream week, your *sustainable* week. Include: focused work blocks, buffer time, recovery blocks, and a hard stop time each day. This becomes your template. Protect it.

Action 2: Create a "not-to-do" list

Write down 5 things you will no longer do by default: checking email first thing in the morning, taking last-minute same-day meetings, saying yes in the moment without a 24-hour hold, working through lunch, staying on after your hard stop. Post it somewhere visible.

Action 3: Establish your capture system

Burnout is worsened by cognitive overload — holding too many open loops in your head. Set up one simple place where everything goes: tasks, ideas, requests, worries. One inbox (a notebook, an app, a doc). Clear it every Sunday. If it doesn't have a home, it's eating your mental RAM.

WEEK 4: PROTECT

Goal: Lock in the new structure. Build early warning detection.

THIS WEEK'S 3 ACTIONS

Action 1: Formalize your weekly planning ritual (see below)

Run the full 15-minute ritual three times this week to make it automatic. By the end of Week 4, it should feel like brushing your teeth — low friction, non-optional.

Action 2: Tell someone what you've changed

Accountability is infrastructure. Tell one person — a partner, a friend, a colleague — what your new limits are. Not to explain yourself. To make it real. When someone else knows your Thursday afternoons are blocked, you're more likely to defend them.

Action 3: Run your Day 30 Sustainability Scorecard (see below)

Do this at the end of Day 30. It tells you what's holding and what still needs work.

THE WEEKLY PLANNING RITUAL

Every Sunday (or your last day off). Under 15 minutes.

Do this in writing. Not in your head.

Step 1 — Clear (3 min)

Brain dump everything sitting in your head: unfinished tasks, upcoming obligations, things you're anxious about. Get it all out of your skull and into your capture system.

Step 2 — Review (4 min)

Look at next week's calendar. Answer three questions:

- Where are the overload risks? (back-to-back meetings, heavy deadlines stacked)
- What can I move, decline, or shorten?
- Do I have at least two recovery blocks scheduled?

Step 3 — Decide (5 min)

Choose your three Most Important Tasks for the week — the ones that, if done, would make the week a success. Write them down. These go on your calendar as protected

blocks, not just your to-do list.

Step 4 — Anticipate (3 min)

Ask: *What is most likely to derail me this week?* Name it. Then write one sentence about how you'll handle it if it shows up.

Total: ~15 minutes. Prevents dozens of hours of reactive chaos.

END-OF-WEEK CHECK-IN PROMPTS

Run every Friday. Takes 5 minutes. Catches problems before they compound.

Answer in writing. Short answers are fine.

1 On a scale of 1–10, how drained do I feel right now? **(Anything under 5 needs immediate attention next week.)**

2 Did I protect my three daily non-negotiables this week? Which ones did I skip?

3 What was the biggest source of unnecessary stress this week? Is it structural (will recur) or situational (one-off)?

4 Did I say yes to anything I should have declined? What made it hard to say no?

5 What's one thing I'll do differently next week based on this week?

Scoring guide:

- **All 5 answered honestly, no major red flags** → System is working. Maintain.
- **1–2 skipped non-negotiables or one structural stress identified** → Adjust next week's plan. Don't wait.
- **3+ skipped non-negotiables or rising dread about Monday** → Pull out your Week 1 stabilization actions. You're drifting back. Reset now.

DAY 30 SUSTAINABILITY SCORECARD

Run this on Day 30. Be honest — this is diagnostic, not judgmental.

Score each item: **0** (not in place), **1** (partially in place), **2** (consistently in place)

| Area | Item | Score |

|---|---|---|

| **Foundation** | Daily non-negotiables maintained 5+ days/week | 0 / 1 / 2 |

| **Foundation** | Consistent sleep anchor in place | 0 / 1 / 2 |

| **Boundaries** | At least one hard limit implemented and holding | 0 / 1 / 2 |

| **Boundaries** | "Not-to-do" list visible and referenced | 0 / 1 / 2 |

| **Structure** | Maximum viable week template in use | 0 / 1 / 2 |

| **Structure** | Capture system

Niche: Overwhelmed professionals experiencing burnout who need a structured recovery and prevention plan · Format:
Action Plan · Generated: June 02, 2026